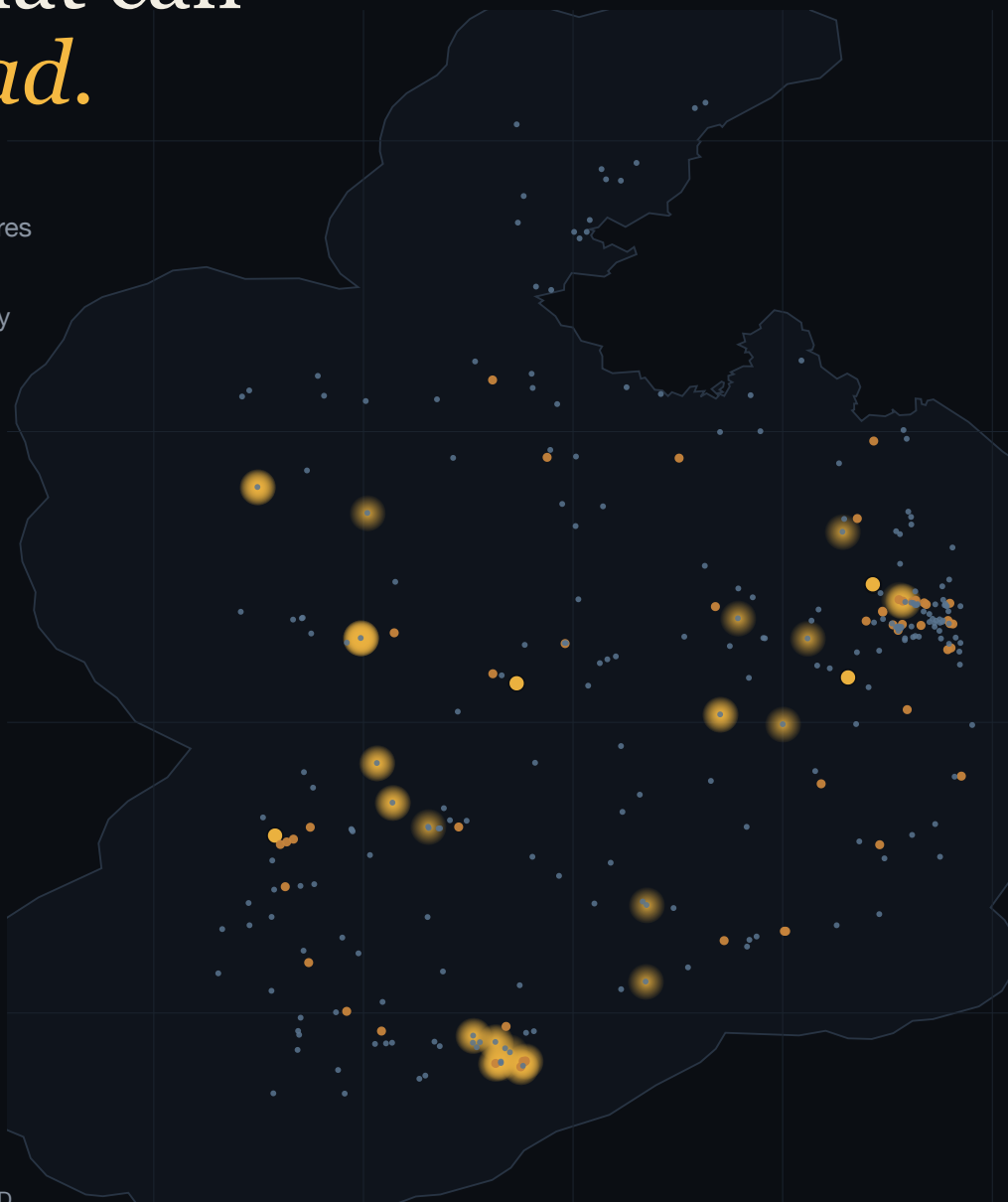


The land that can take the *load*.

Every industrial-zoned parcel in the Republic of Ireland within 1,000 metres of the national transmission grid — measured, scored and independently verified for data-centre siting.



289

TRANSMISSION STATIONS MAPPED

580

ZONED PARCELS WITHIN 1,000 M

308

INSIDE 500 M OF THE GRID

39

PRIME NON-DUBLIN SITES

● 400 kV ● 220 kV ● 110 kV

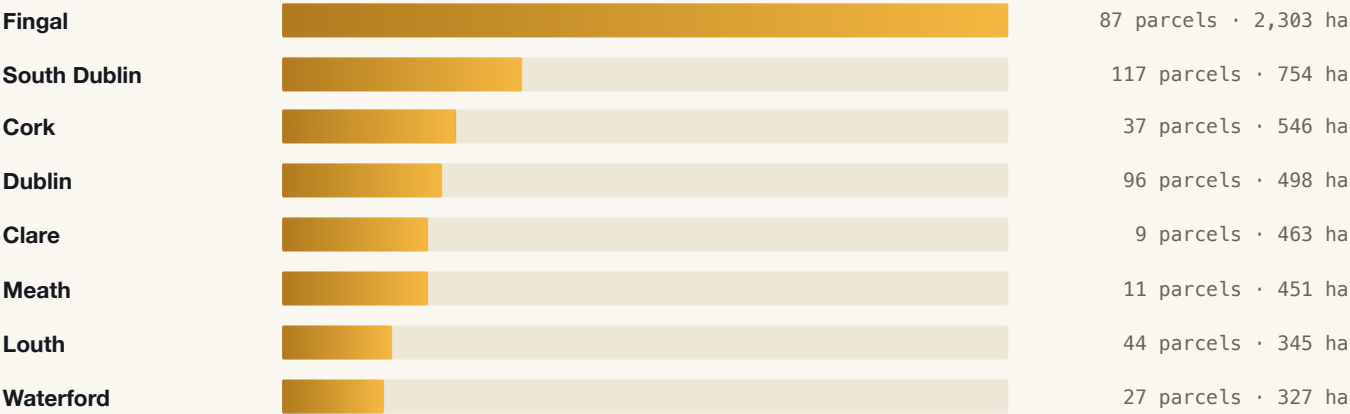
glow = prime site (≤ 500 m · primary industrial · ≥ 5 ha)

One question, measured *everywhere at once.*

Where in Ireland does land that is already zoned for industry sit beside a grid connection strong enough for a data centre? This analysis answers it for the whole Republic in a single pass: every transmission station at 110 kV and above, against every industrial and enterprise zoning polygon in the national planning dataset, with the true minimum distance computed for each pair.

01 Map the grid 289 transmission stations (5 × 400 kV, 50 × 220 kV, 234 × 110 kV) with coordinates, deduplicated from OpenStreetMap grid data and anchored to EirGrid records.	02 Load the zoning The Government's Generalised Zoning Types dataset — the statutory composite of all 31 local-authority development plans — filtered to six industrial & enterprise categories.	03 Measure & score Exact metre distance from each station to each parcel boundary. Scored on proximity, voltage, zoning strength, scale, and the live CRU Dublin connection policy.	04 Verify independently A second model (Claude Sonnet) re-checked top sites, station identities and policy claims against primary sources before anything here was called done.
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Where the opportunity concentrates



The model proves itself. Ranked blind, on distance, voltage, zoning and scale alone, the analysis put the Bracetown–Clonee corridor in Co. Meath at #1 nationally. That corridor is where Meta built its Irish data-centre campus — 330–460 m from the Bracetown 220 kV station. The scoring finds, independently, the same ground the biggest operator in the country chose.

Top 20 sites *nationally*.

One row per zoning parcel, held against its nearest transmission station. "On-site" means the station sits inside or on the boundary of the zoned land. Score is out of 100: proximity 30 · voltage 30 · zoning strength 20 · scale 20, with the CRU Dublin policy applied as a discount, not an exclusion. **Headroom** is ESB's official spare capacity in MVA (Dec 2025): Clonee shows 0.0 — Meta consumed the node — while Dalton holds 56.5 beside 39 ha. "TSO" = transmission-level connection, assessed by EirGrid.

	SITE / STATION	GRID	DISTANCE	ZONING	EXTENT	HEADROOM	MVA	SCORE
01	Aghada complex (second OSM feature) Cork	220kV	on-site	C2.1 Industry	67 ha	TSO		92
02	Aghada 220kV Cork	220kV	70m	C2.1 Industry	30 ha	2.3		92
03	Bracetown 220kV Meath	220kV	on-site	C2.1 E2/E3 - General Ente	210 ha	TSO		92
04	Clonee 220kV Meath	220kV	on-site	C2.1 E2/E3 - General Ente	69 ha	0.0		92
05	Glanagow 220 kV Cork	220kV	44m	C2.1 Industry	56 ha	TSO		92
06	Glanagow 220 kV Cork	220kV	on-site	C2.1 Industry	88 ha	TSO		92
07	Moneypoint 400kV Station Clare	400kV	on-site	C7 Marine Related Indus	281 ha	TSO		90
08	Clonee 220kV Meath	220kV	142m	C2.1 E2/E3 - General Ente	11 ha	0.0		87
09	Raffeen 220 kV Cork	220kV	69m	C2.1 Industry	15 ha	38.7		87
10	Raffeen 220 kV Cork	220kV	329m	C2.1 Industry	13 ha	38.7		87
11	Leixlip (Intel) 220kV Kildare	220kV	on-site	C6 Industry and Warehou	74 ha	TSO		82
12	110kV Kilbarry Electrical Cork	110kV	110m	C2.1 Light Industry and R	36 ha	0.0		82
13	Anner 110kV Tipperary	110kV	on-site	C2.2 General Industry	55 ha	TSO		82
14	Athy 110kV Kildare	110kV	41m	C2.1 Enterprise and Emplo	24 ha	0.1		82
15	Carrowbeg 110 kV Mayo	110kV	188m	C2.1 Enterprise & Employment	28 ha	18.2		82
16	Castlevew 110kV Cork	110kV	357m	C2.2 Industry	27 ha	6.8		82
17	Castlevew 110kV Cork	110kV	95m	C2.1 Business and General	36 ha	6.8		82
18	Dalton 110kV Mayo	110kV	469m	C2.2 Industry	39 ha	56.5		82
19	Drumline 110kV Clare	110kV	147m	C2.1 Light Industry	81 ha	0.4		82
20	Drumline 110kV Clare	110kV	373m	C2.1 Light Industry	20 ha	0.4		82

Nothing here is *taken on trust*.

Every layer was assembled from a sourced dataset, then independently re-checked by a second model against primary sources. Confirmed means two independent reads agree. Open items are stated, not hidden.

CONFIRMED	All 20 top-ranked zoning parcels Every parcel re-pulled live from the Government GZT service by ID on 2 July 2026: 20/20 zone codes, local authorities and current-plan status match.
CONFIRMED	All 14 top-ranked stations Every station individually verified against EirGrid project records (CP codes, Network Delivery Portfolio) or equivalent primary sources across three verification passes.
CONFIRMED	Bracetown 220kV + Meta corridor, Meath Meta Clonee campus 330–460m south — the model independently ranked this corridor Ireland's #1 before that was known.
CONFIRMED	Clonee 220kV as a distinct station Genuinely separate from Bracetown: the 12-bay, 267 MVA connection built for the Meta campus (HNV Engineering / EirGrid portfolio). ESB data shows its demand headroom now at 0.0 MVA.
CONFIRMED	Moneypoint 400kV, Clare ESB 'Green Atlantic' green-hub programme confirmed live (coal ended June 2025).
IDENTIFIED	Leixlip 220kV, Kildare (name withheld in OSM) The 220kV station EirGrid built to serve the Intel Leixlip campus (Irish Times / EirGrid).
CONFIRMED	Capacity headroom layer ESB Networks Customer Heatmap (Dec 2025 edition): official Demand Available MVA per station, matched to 499 of 580 parcels. Indicative pending a formal connection study.
CORRECTED	Dublin connection rule CRU replaced the blanket moratorium in Dec 2025 with conditional connections (localised constraint tests + 80% renewables obligation). Scoring uses the live policy.
RECONCILED	National station count (289) ESB's official demand-serving HV list holds 146 stations; our 289 adds TSO-only and generator-connection stations from grid mapping. Both lenses stated; top-ranked stations all individually confirmed.

Honest limits. Headroom figures are ESB's indicative demand capacity (Dec 2025) and are not a connection offer — a formal study governs any real project. TSO-connected stations' capacity sits with EirGrid and is not in the DSO dataset. Zoning is the statutory composite; a planning consultant should confirm data-centre permissibility within each zone before any commitment. Site-level ground truth (ownership, availability, services) is beyond any dataset and belongs to the next phase.

SOURCES · EirGrid Transmission System Map & Network Delivery Portfolio Q2 2025 (cms.eirgrid.ie) · Dept. of Housing, Local Government & Heritage — Generalised Zoning Types national dataset (services.arcgis.com/NzlPQPKn5QF9v2US, live pull 2 July 2026) · ESB Networks Customer Heatmap, December 2025 edition (esbnetworks.ie) · OpenStreetMap power infrastructure (lz4.overpass-api.de, 2 July 2026) · CRU decision on electricity connection policy for data centres (Dec 2025, cru.ie) · ESB Green Atlantic @ Moneypoint · Independent verification: Claude Sonnet, 2 July 2026.